



# LG 4K Smart Monitor: How good is it?

Hint: It made me rethink my stance on 8K TVs

Deepak Singh | editor@digit.in

**F**or the longest time, I've considered 8K TVs to be a case of technology overshooting practicality. The content simply isn't there yet, and 4K already delivers excellent sharpness on most modern displays. My wish list has always leaned toward better HDR, improved contrast, and superior colour accuracy – not just more pixels. So when I started reviewing LG's new 27-inch 4K Smart Monitor 27SR75U, I

wasn't expecting a resolution epiphany, but I was pleasantly surprised.

Let's proceed with the review.

## What is a smart monitor?

Smart monitors like this one from LG are designed to blend the capabilities of a display with the smarts of a streaming device. Unlike regular monitors, these come with their own processor, operating system, and access to apps like Netflix, Prime Video, and YouTube, all without needing a connected PC.

Even though both TVs and monitors are predominantly displays, they're tuned a bit differently. Monitors are often sharper and tuned for precise colour gamuts – mostly sRGB – while TVs often push for boosted colours and wider colour gamuts.

TVs that don't have a PC mode may default to 4:2:0/4:2:2 Chroma subsampling over HDMI, reducing text clarity vs. most monitors that stick to 4:4:4 to avoid fringing around texts. TVs usually incorporate heavy post-processing while monitors prioritise direct signal passthrough for a more responsive experience, which also matters when you are working with your mouse and keyboard.

Smart monitors are meant to bridge this gap. Of course, you can turn a regular monitor into a smart one by plugging in a streaming device like a Fire TV Stick or Apple TV. However, these devices are typically optimised for premium TVs with advanced display features, so the experience on a conventional low-end and mid-range monitor might not always be consistent, especially when it comes to colour accuracy, motion clarity, and HDR. The experience might still be perfectly satisfactory for casual viewing

## Experience as a TV

There's something about seeing 4K resolution packed into a compact 27-inch display that just hits differently. The pixel density is high; thus, everything from text to images to UI elements appears exquisitely sharp. But over and above these expected benefits, this extra crispness also added to my cinema experience even from a considerable viewing distance. This makes me think that perhaps extra resolution isn't overkill and makes me want to revisit 8K on TVs.

This impact, however, would have been lost without a properly tuned display. Compared to affordable TVs (even QLED options) that we have reviewed in the affordable segment, this one offers better colour accuracy and screen uniformity.

LG is using an IPS LCD panel, which makes sense from the monitor point of view. The viewing angles are wide, and we measured a maximum contrast ratio of approximately 1000:1. The anti-reflective coating on the display is also of good quality, which can